

the red one into whichever port is used for DC voltage. In the example image on the right, you'll have a range labelled with the DC Voltage symbol. This range happens to be associated with the mAVΩ port on the Sparkfun VC830L multimeter. So plug your red cable into the mAVΩ port. Now, set the multimeter to AV in direct current (DC) range. Next, connect the black probe to the AA battery's ground or '-' and the red probe to power or '+'. You will need to apply some pressure with the probes to the negative and positive ends of the battery. The display will now display the voltage, which should be around 1.5V if the battery is fresh or slightly lower if it's older. Also, different chemicals have different voltage levels. Example: a NiCd and NiMH battery will have different levels.

To measure DC voltage (such as a battery or sensor attached to an Arduino), set the knob to the point where the V has a straight line. Additionally, if you want to mess around with AC voltage, get a non-contact tester rather than a digital multimeter since this process could be dangerous. Also, be careful when testing power because you could accidentally short circuit the power supply. With NiMH or NiCD batteries, there might be a bit of heating. With LiPo batteries, there might be an explosion. So be careful.



Measuring resistance

Through-hole resistors have colour codes on them which can be easily used to decipher the resistance value as well as the tolerance. However, not knowing how to decipher the code doesn't necessarily spell doom since there are multiple online calculators which will help you. Let's just say that you've have a paint spill on your

